



DIGITAL VECTOR

Empowering responsible
digital citizens.

Digital Citizenship & Online Safety

Six print-and-go lessons on reputation, account security, data, verification, consent, and fraud.

Real-world
skills for a
safer digital
future.

THE SIX LESSONS

1



Reputation and the Record

Build a positive digital footprint.

2



Account Security and Breach Response

Protect accounts and respond with confidence.

3



Data, Inference and Attention

Understand data, privacy and online attention.

4



Verification and Synthetic Media

Spot misinformation and AI-generated content.

5



Consent, Harassment and the Law

Know your rights and respect others online.

6



Money, Fraud and Manipulation

Recognise scams and make smart choices.



Print-and-go
Easy to use, no prep needed.



Student-friendly
Engaging, relevant and age-appropriate.



Curriculum aligned
Meets ISTE, CASEL and AASL standards.



Real-world ready
Practical skills students use every day.

WHAT YOU GET



6 complete lessons with teacher notes and student pages



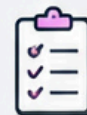
Key topics covered reputation, security, data, verification, consent, fraud & more



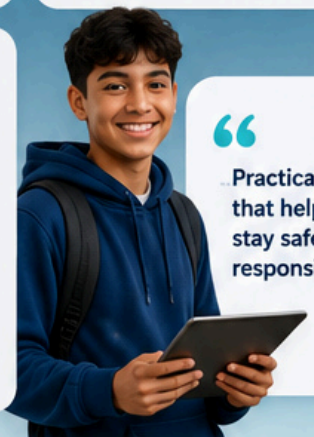
Skills practice six exit tickets and a full answer key



Family letter & student help sheet with real reporting services



Standards alignment for ISTE, CASEL and AASL



“

Practical lessons that help me stay safe and responsible online.

”



FOR TEACHERS

Save time with ready-to-use lessons your class will love.



FOR PARENTS

Trusted content that supports conversations at home.



FOR STUDENTS

Build confidence, make smart choices, and thrive online.



Better digital citizens. Safer online communities. Stronger futures.

Start Here

Six lessons that give high school students the actual picture, including the legal exposure and the fraud schemes aimed directly at their age group.

What this pack is

- **Six complete lessons** covering the areas students actually get caught by: footprints, passwords, privacy, unkindness, false information, and scams.
- **Every lesson runs from the page.** Teacher notes on one side, student pages on the other. No slides to prepare, no accounts to create, no websites to visit.
- **Print and go.** Black and white printing works. Nothing here breaks if the internet is down.
- **Written for any teacher**, not just the tech teacher. If you have never taught this before, the teacher page tells you exactly what to say and do.

THE THREE-PART SHAPE OF EVERY LESSON

PART	TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
Open	5 to 8 min	A question or a short scenario on the board. Everyone has an opinion, so everyone talks.
Work	20 to 30 min	Students complete the pages. You circulate. The pages carry the content, so you are free to listen.
Land	7 to 10 min	A short share-back and an exit ticket. This is where the rule gets stated out loud.

PRINT SETUP

Student pages are the ones with a **Grades 9 to 12** footer and space to write. Print them single-sided if students will keep them in a folder, double-sided to save paper. Teacher pages are marked **TEACHER** in the top right corner and are not meant for students.

A NOTE ON TONE

These lessons assume capable young adults and say difficult things plainly, including the legal position on intimate images and the fact that confidence is a risk factor in fraud rather than a defense. Nothing here is delivered as a threat to the class. The consistent message is that reporting early is always the right move and that the responsibility for harm sits with the person who caused it.

What Is Inside

Six lessons, plus everything you need to run them and check what stuck.

THE LESSONS

#	LESSON	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS	TIME
Lesson 1	Reputation and the Record	Your record was assembled without a plan. Who will read it, and what will they conclude?	55 min
Lesson 2	Account Security and Breach Response	Your password will leak. It is a question of when. What survives that?	55 min
Lesson 3	Data, Inference and Attention	If the product is free, what is being sold, and to whom?	55 min
Lesson 4	Verification and Synthetic Media	Every traditional signal of credibility can now be manufactured. What is left?	55 min
Lesson 5	Consent, Harassment and the Law	Consent to one person, at one moment, for one purpose. What does that actually cover?	55 min
Lesson 6	Money, Fraud and Manipulation	Fraud is engineered by professionals and tested at scale. So why do we treat victims as if they were careless?	55 min

ALSO INCLUDED

SECTION	USE IT FOR
Standards alignment	Dropping into a unit plan or showing a coordinator what this covers.
Pacing options	Running the pack over one week, six weeks, or a single day.
Before you teach	Two pages of guidance on disclosures, privacy, and what not to ask students to share.
Skills rubric	A single-page rubric that works across all six lessons.
Exit tickets	Six short tickets, one per lesson, cut-and-go.
Family letter	An editable-tone letter home explaining what students are learning and why.
Help sheet	A page students fill in <i>before</i> they need it, listing who they would tell.
Answer key	Full answers, including model responses for the open questions.

HOW LONG IT TAKES

All six lessons run about **5.5 hours** of class time. Most teachers spread them across six weeks, one lesson a week. You can also pull a single lesson out and run it on its own; nothing depends on anything before it except the vocabulary, which is defined again each time.

Standards Alignment

Use these when you need to justify the time. Copy the codes straight into a unit plan.

ISTE STANDARDS FOR STUDENTS

CODE	STANDARD	LESSONS
1.2.a	Students manage their digital identity and reputation and understand the permanence of their actions.	1
1.2.b	Students engage in safe, legal and ethical behavior when using technology.	5, 6
1.2.c	Students respect the rights and obligations of using and sharing intellectual property.	1, 5
1.2.d	Students manage personal data for privacy and security, and understand data-collection technology.	2, 3
1.3.b	Students evaluate the accuracy, credibility and relevance of information and media.	4
1.3.d	Students build knowledge by exploring real-world issues and developing ideas.	3, 4

CASEL COMPETENCIES

COMPETENCY	HOW THE PACK ADDRESSES IT	LESSONS
Self-awareness	The motivated-reasoning self-audit asks students to examine their own evaluation bias directly.	4
Self-management	Response protocols in Lessons 2, 5 and 6 create rehearsed sequences for high-stress moments.	2, 5, 6
Social awareness	The consent framework requires students to model another person's understanding, not their own.	5
Relationship skills	Students script both the disclosure and the response to a disclosure.	5, 6
Responsible decision-making	Every lesson requires evaluating trade-offs and committing to a specific action.	All

AASL NATIONAL SCHOOL LIBRARY STANDARDS

SHARED FOUNDATION	ALIGNMENT	LESSONS
Inquire	Lateral reading and provenance analysis as routine practice.	4
Include	Students argue positions they do not personally hold.	1, 3
Collaborate	Consent, forwarding, and the collective responsibility of a group.	5
Curate	Evaluating sources and deciding what should stop with them.	4
Engage	Legal and ethical use of information about self and others.	1, 5

STATE STANDARDS

Most states now require some form of internet safety or media literacy instruction. The lesson objectives on each teacher page are written as observable student behaviors, which makes them easy to map onto whatever wording your state uses. If you need a specific crosswalk, the objectives are the piece to quote.

Pacing Options

Three ways to run the same six lessons. Pick the one that matches the time you actually have.

OPTION A: ONE LESSON A WEEK FOR SIX WEEKS

The version that sticks best. A week between lessons gives students time to notice the thing you named, which is what turns a lesson into a habit. Open each week by asking whether anyone saw last week's idea show up.

OPTION B: ONE INTENSIVE WEEK

DAY	LESSON	NOTE
Monday	Lesson 1: Reputation and the Record	Sets the analytical frame. Do not skip.
Tuesday	Lesson 2: Account Security and Breach Response	Most immediately actionable.
Wednesday	Lesson 3: Data, Inference and Attention	The most discussion-heavy. Protect the time.
Thursday	Lesson 5: Consent, Harassment and the Law	Deliberately mid-week, not Friday. Preview it first.
Friday	Lessons 4 and 6, shortened	Lesson 4 page 1, then Lesson 6 in full plus the help sheet.

OPTION C: A SINGLE DAY

Run Lessons 1, 2 and 6. Skip the extension tasks and use the exit tickets as the only written record. This is the version to use for an assembly day, a sub day, or the first week of school.

IF YOU ONLY HAVE ONE PERIOD, EVER

The 45-minute version

- **Minutes 0 to 10.** Lesson 1 opener and the first student page only.
- **Minutes 10 to 25.** Lesson 2 student pages. This is the highest-value single activity in the pack.
- **Minutes 25 to 40.** Lesson 6 scenario cards, discussed as a whole class rather than written.
- **Minutes 40 to 45.** The help sheet at the back. Every student fills it in and keeps it.

SUBSTITUTE FRIENDLY

Every teacher page is self-contained, so a substitute can run any lesson cold. Leave the teacher page and the matching student pages on the desk and nothing else needs explaining.

Before You Teach

This topic reaches into students' actual lives. A few decisions made in advance keep the room safe.

THE DESIGN RULE BEHIND THIS PACK

No page in this pack asks a student to write down a real password, a real account name, a real message they received, or a real person's name. Every scenario is fictional. This is deliberate: worksheets get left on desks, collected, photographed, and taken home. Please keep this rule if you adapt anything.

WHAT TO SAY IN THE FIRST TWO MINUTES

"Over the next few weeks we are covering online safety, and I am going to treat you as adults, which means some of this is blunter than you may be used to. Some of it may be close to something you or someone you know has experienced. You are never required to share anything personal in this room. If something comes up you want to talk about, come find me and we will work out what to do."

IF A STUDENT DISCLOSES SOMETHING

WHAT YOU HEAR	WHAT TO DO
A student names something that happened to them in front of the class	Thank them, keep your face neutral, and move the conversation back to the general case. Follow up privately after the lesson.
A student writes something concerning on a page	Do not read it aloud or return it to the pile. Follow your school's reporting process the same day.
A student names another student as the person who did something	Stop the naming immediately and kindly. Say that the class talks about behavior, not people. Record it and pass it on.
A student says something that suggests harm to themselves or someone else	This goes to your counselor or designated safeguarding lead the same day, no exceptions and no promises of secrecy.

DO NOT PROMISE CONFIDENTIALITY

If a student says "can I tell you something but you can't tell anyone," the honest answer is that you will keep it as private as you can, but if someone is being hurt you have to pass it on to one specific person whose job it is to help. Say this *before* they tell you, not after.

TWO THINGS WORTH CHECKING WITH YOUR SCHOOL FIRST

- **Your reporting pathway.** Know the name of the person you would go to, today, before you start Lesson 1. Write it on the teacher page.
- **Your device policy.** Some of these lessons discuss platform features. If your school has rules about naming specific apps, the lessons work without naming any.

Before You Teach: Handling the Hard Bits

THE FOUR QUESTIONS STUDENTS ALWAYS ASK

QUESTION	A STRAIGHT ANSWER
"Can I actually get charged for this?"	Yes. Intimate images of anyone under 18 are child sexual abuse material under federal law regardless of who created them. Minors have been prosecuted. State the fact plainly, without threatening the class.
"What if it already happened to me?"	Say: come see me after class, there are services for this, and you are not in trouble. Do not invite disclosure in front of the room. Follow your school's process the same day.
"Isn't privacy already gone?"	Partly, and that is not a reason to stop. Distinguish controls that reduce collection from controls that only change what you are shown.
"Why would I report a scam? Nothing happens."	Reporting speed determines whether funds can be recovered, and reports drive platform enforcement. Under-reporting is why the same scheme runs repeatedly.

LANGUAGE THAT WORKS, AND LANGUAGE THAT BACKFIRES

INSTEAD OF	SAY
"Don't be so naive"	"These are engineered by teams and tested at scale"
"You should have known better"	"Confidence is a risk factor here, not a defense"
"Why did you send it in the first place?"	"The person who threatened you is the one who committed an offense"
"Just delete everything"	"Preserve the evidence, then stop responding"
"This will follow you forever"	"This record is read by people who will never ask for context"

WHY THE SCARE APPROACH FAILS

Fear-based internet safety teaching has a poor evidence record. Students either decide the risk is exaggerated and discount everything you said, or they become anxious and stop telling adults anything. Both outcomes make them less safe. Every lesson here is built on **what to do** rather than **what to be afraid of**, which is why the exit tickets ask for an action, not a feeling.

PREPARE THESE THREE THINGS ONCE

1. **The help sheet.** Print one per student now. It is the last student page in this pack and it is the single most useful page in it.
2. **Your reporting name.** One person, first and last name, and where to find them. Students will ask.
3. **A copy of your school's acceptable use policy.** Students in the older lessons will ask what the actual rules are, and it lands better if you can show them.

A word about students who already know this

In every class there are two or three students who are more technically capable than most adults they know. They will be visibly bored by the password lesson. Use them: give them the extension task early, and ask them to explain one idea to the class in their own words. Students who are ahead here are usually ahead precisely because someone once explained it to them well.

Lesson 1: Reputation and the Record

Students examine the record that already exists about them and how it will be read by people with power over their next step.

Students will be able to

- Distinguish disclosed, observed and inferred data in their own record.
- Analyze how context collapse changes the meaning of unchanged content.
- Evaluate the limits of deletion and produce a specific audit plan.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 55 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

Your record was assembled without a plan. Who will read it, and what will they conclude?

RUNNING THE LESSON

0 to 9 Who reads it, and with what power

List the audiences on the board: admissions offices, employers, scholarship committees, coaches, landlords, background-check firms, and eventually people who matter to them personally. Ask which of those audiences will ever ask for context. The answer is none, and that reframes the whole topic away from rules and toward asymmetry.

9 to 20 Context collapse and the asymmetry of interpretation

The reader has full access and no context. They see a post but not the conversation, the year, the joke, or who you were at fifteen. Point out that this is not fair, and that fairness is not the operating condition. Students respond much better to the honest framing than to a warning.

20 to 36 Student pages 1 and 2

Students map their record into three tiers, then run a full inference audit on a fictional profile. Push them past the obvious. The exercise is about what can be concluded, not what was stated.

36 to 48 Student page 3

The limits of deletion, and a specific audit plan. Insist on specific actions with a named setting or account, not intentions.

48 to 55 Land it

Ask for one action anyone will complete within 48 hours. Exit ticket 1 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Context collapse	When content produced for one audience is read by an audience it was never written for.
Inference	A conclusion drawn about you from indirect signals, often probabilistic and often acted on as if certain.
Data broker	A company that aggregates and sells personal data compiled from many sources.
Right to erasure	A legal right to have personal data deleted. Broad in the EU, patchy in the US, and dependent on state law.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Provide the three-tier categories pre-labeled with two examples each. The concept is not the barrier; the blank page is.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to write the two-paragraph summary a background-check firm would produce from their public record, then annotate which parts are accurate, which are inferred, and which are simply absent.

WATCH FOR

Do not ask students to search themselves or each other in class. It exposes students who have content online they did not consent to, and it turns an analytical lesson into a comparison exercise.

Three Tiers of Record

The record is larger than the posts

Most people picture their online record as their posts. Posts are the smallest and most controllable tier.

Disclosed. What you entered or published deliberately.

Observed. Behavioral data: dwell time, location history, purchase records, what you searched and then deleted, what you typed and did not send, which posts you scrolled past quickly.

Inferred. Conclusions drawn from the first two: probable age, income band, health status, political leaning, relationship status, who you likely know. **You disclosed none of it, and it is the tier with commercial value.**

MAP YOUR OWN RECORD

Categories, not confessions. Write types of data rather than actual data.

DISCLOSED	OBSERVED	INFERRED

QUESTION 1

Which tier could you most easily change tomorrow? Which has the largest effect on how you are treated? Explain why those are not the same tier.

QUESTION 2

An inference can be wrong and still have consequences: a system can price, rank, or reject you on a conclusion that does not describe you. Explain why an inaccurate inference is harder to contest than an inaccurate disclosure.

What Can Be Concluded

A fictional applicant's public record. Determine what a reader with no context could conclude, and how confident they could reasonably be.

PUBLIC RECORD FOR A 17-YEAR-OLD APPLICANT
Platform A: Photos over four years. A team uniform with a school name. A part-time job apron with a company logo. A graduation-year post.
Platform B: Sharp, sarcastic commentary. Two posts, from age 14, mocking a named classmate. A deleted account is referenced by friends in the comments.
Platform C: A public playlist, a public reading list, and reviews left on local businesses under a username that matches Platform A.
Elsewhere: Tagged in others' photos at events. Named in a local newspaper article about a sports result. A years-old comment on a public forum under the same username.

BUILD THE PROFILE A READER WOULD CONSTRUCT

CONCLUSION	EVIDENCE	CONFIDENCE	FAIR?

QUESTION 1

The consistent username across platforms is the single most consequential detail here. Explain why.

QUESTION 2

The two mocking posts were written at 14. Argue both sides: why a reader might reasonably discount them, and why a reader might reasonably not.

REASONABLE TO DISCOUNT BECAUSE	REASONABLE TO WEIGH BECAUSE
Name: _____ Date: _____	digitalvector.com.au

Deletion, and What Replaces It

WHY DELETION UNDERPERFORMS

Deleting removes content from your view. It does not reliably remove screenshots, reposts, archived copies, cached versions, platform-retained records, or anything already forwarded off-platform. Deletion is a useful step and a poor strategy. **The workable strategy is not producing the material, and reducing what is collected.**

WHAT DELETION DOES AND DOES NOT REACH

THE CONTENT	DOES DELETING YOUR COPY REMOVE IT?	WHAT ACTUALLY HELPS
A post that got fewer than five views		
A post that was screenshotted		
A photo someone else posted of you		
Search history held by the platform		
A comment on a public forum, indexed by search engines		

QUESTION 1

Row 3 is content posted by somebody else. Outline the realistic options, and be honest about how strong each one is.

QUESTION 2

The EU grants a broad right to erasure. In the US the position depends on state law and is far narrower. Argue for or against a broad US right to erasure. Name one serious cost of the position you are arguing for.

MY AUDIT: THREE SPECIFIC ACTIONS

Each must name a platform, a setting, or an account. "Be more careful" is not an action.

1

Name: _____ Date: _____

digitalvector.com.au

Lesson 2: Account Security and Breach Response

Students learn the actual threat model behind account compromise and rehearse a correctly ordered response.

Students will be able to

- Explain credential stuffing and why reuse dominates password strength as a risk.
- Compare authentication factors and rank them by resistance to specific attacks.
- Sequence a breach response correctly, including the steps most people omit.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 55 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

Your password will leak. It is a question of when. What survives that?

RUNNING THE LESSON

- 0 to 9** **Assume the password is already gone**
Open with the premise: assume every password you have ever used is already in a leaked dataset somewhere. This is close to true for most people. Then ask what still protects an account under that assumption. Only two answers survive: uniqueness and a second factor.
- 9 to 21** **The factor hierarchy, and why SMS sits low**
Walk the hierarchy: password, SMS code, authenticator app, push approval, hardware key, passkey. Explain SIM swap and real-time phishing relay. The key insight is that a code a human can read and retype is a code a human can be tricked into retyping into the wrong place, which is why passkeys and hardware keys are categorically different.
- 21 to 37** **Student pages 1 and 2**
Students trace a compromise, then rank factors against named attacks. The ranking table is the analytical core of the lesson.
- 37 to 49** **Student page 3**
Breach response sequencing and the persistence mechanisms most people miss: forwarding rules, altered recovery addresses, app passwords, and active sessions.
- 49 to 55** **Land it**
Ask what an attacker leaves behind so that changing your password does not lock them out. Exit ticket 2 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Credential stuffing	Automated reuse of leaked username and password pairs against unrelated services.
SIM swap	Persuading or bribing a carrier to move a phone number to an attacker's SIM, defeating SMS codes.
Phishing-resistant MFA	Second factors that cannot be relayed by a fake login page, such as passkeys and hardware keys.
Passkey	A private key stored on your device, unlocked biometrically. Nothing shared, nothing to leak, nothing to phish.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Provide the attack definitions on a reference card. The ranking task is doable without memorizing the attacks, but not without having them in front of you.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to write a one-page security recommendation for a small organization with a limited budget, ordered by cost per unit of risk reduced, and to justify what they left out.

WATCH FOR

Never ask a student to state or write a real password. If a student volunteers one aloud, stop them and tell them privately afterward to change it everywhere it is used.

Assume It Has Already Leaked

The realistic threat model

The common picture of account compromise is an attacker guessing a password. That is rare. The normal path is that a company you signed up to years ago was breached, your email and password pair entered a leaked dataset, and automated software now tries that pair against hundreds of services.

This is **credential stuffing**, and it explains a counterintuitive fact: **a reused strong password is a larger risk than a unique weak one**. The unique weak password costs you one account. The reused strong one costs you every account it touches.

TRACE THE BLAST RADIUS

A person reused one strong passphrase. A retailer they used once in 2019 is breached. Work through it.

ACCOUNT	FALLS?	CONSEQUENCE	WHAT WOULD HAVE STOPPED IT
The breached retailer	Yes		
Personal email			
Cloud storage			
Social media			
A banking or payment app			
School or work account			

QUESTION 1

Email is the highest-value target regardless of its contents. Explain the mechanism precisely.

QUESTION 2

Password rotation policies, forcing a change every 90 days, were standard for decades and are now discouraged by NIST. Suggest why forced frequent rotation made security worse in practice.

Ranking the Factors

Six authentication methods against four attacks. Mark each cell: **stops it**, **slows it**, or **no help**.

METHOD	CREDENTIAL STUFFING	REAL-TIME PHISHING PAGE	SIM SWAP	DEVICE THEFT (UNLOCKED)
Reused password				
Unique password in a manager				
SMS one-time code				
Authenticator app code				
Hardware security key				
Passkey				

QUESTION 1

A real-time phishing page relays your code to the genuine site the moment you type it. Explain why that defeats an authenticator app code but not a passkey.

QUESTION 2

SMS codes are widely criticized by security professionals, and they remain the most common second factor in use. Give two reasons that gap persists.

QUESTION 3

Argue the strongest case **against** password managers, then answer it. A good answer takes the objection seriously rather than dismissing it.

THE STRONGEST OBJECTION

YOUR ANSWER

Name: _____ Date: _____ digitalvector.com.au

Breach Response

PART A: SEQUENCE IT

Number 1 to 8. Order determines whether the attacker is actually removed.

- ☐ Change passwords on every account sharing the compromised credential
- ☐ Revoke active sessions and connected devices
- ☐ Secure the email account first, since it controls resets everywhere
- ☐ Audit forwarding rules, filters, and the recovery email and phone
- ☐ Enable phishing-resistant MFA on the recovered account
- ☐ Revoke third-party app authorizations and app-specific passwords
- ☐ Notify anyone the attacker may have messaged from your account
- ☐ Tell a trusted adult, and report it if money or images are involved

PART B: PERSISTENCE

An attacker who expects to be discovered leaves ways back in. Name four, and say what each survives.

PERSISTENCE MECHANISM	WHAT IT SURVIVES

PART C: THE STEP ALMOST EVERYONE OMITTS

Notifying contacts feels embarrassing and unnecessary. Explain why omitting it converts your compromise into someone else's.

PART D: MY PRIORITY ORDER

Rank your own three highest-value accounts and name the specific control you will add to each.

ACCOUNT	CONTROL TO ADD	BY WHEN

Lesson 3: Data, Inference and Attention

Students analyze the business model behind the products they use and evaluate which controls meaningfully change it.

Students will be able to

- Explain how inference generates the commercial value in behavioral data.
- Identify dark patterns and describe the choice each one steers toward.
- Evaluate privacy controls by effect rather than by how prominently they are offered.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 55 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

If the product is free, what is being sold, and to whom?

RUNNING THE LESSON

0 to 10

Price the free product

Ask students to estimate the annual cost of running a large social platform. The number is enormous. Then ask what they have paid. This establishes that a transaction occurred, and the rest of the lesson identifies its terms.

10 to 22

Inference is the product

Raw behavior is cheap. Prediction is valuable. The saleable asset is not what you did but what you will probably do, and to whom you are probably similar. Note that inferences about people who never used a service can be built from the behavior of people who did.

22 to 38

Student pages 1 and 2

Students analyze an inference chain, then evaluate dark patterns. Push for precision on what each pattern steers toward and what the honest version would look like.

38 to 49

Student page 3

Engagement optimization and the controls audit. The controls list is deliberately short because long lists get abandoned.

49 to 55

Land it

Ask what distinguishes a control that changes collection from one that changes only what you are shown. Exit ticket 3 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Behavioral surplus	Data collected beyond what is needed to run the service, used to predict behavior.
Data broker	A firm that aggregates personal data from many sources and sells profiles.
Dark pattern	Interface design that steers users toward the choice the company prefers.
Engagement optimization	Ranking content by predicted interaction rather than by accuracy or value.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Model the first inference chain aloud, thinking through each step explicitly, before students attempt their own.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to write the terms of the exchange as an explicit contract in plain language: what each party provides, what each receives, and which terms either side may change unilaterally.

WATCH FOR

A common endpoint is fatalism: privacy is gone, nothing matters. Address it directly. Some controls measurably reduce collection, and the realistic goal is reducing exposure rather than eliminating it.

From Behavior to Prediction

Why observation is not the valuable part

Knowing that you watched a video is worth very little. Knowing what you are likely to do next week, and which advertisers should bid to influence it, is worth a great deal.

The pipeline runs: **observation**, then **aggregation** across services and devices, then **inference**, then **prediction**, then **targeting**. Value is created at the inference step, which is also the step you cannot see, cannot correct, and did not agree to individually.

BUILD THE CHAIN

For each observed signal, write a plausible inference and then the commercial use.

OBSERVED SIGNAL	PLAUSIBLE INFERENCE	COMMERCIAL USE
Scroll speed slows on certain content		
Location overlaps nightly with another user's		
Purchases shift toward unscented products		
App opened repeatedly between 1am and 4am		
Search performed, then immediately deleted		
Battery consistently low by early evening		

QUESTION 1

Rows 3 and 4 support inferences that most people would consider sensitive. Explain why sensitivity here is determined by the inference rather than by the data.

QUESTION 2

A person who has never used a platform can still be profiled by it. Explain the mechanism.

Designed to Steer

DARK PATTERNS

Interfaces encode intentions. A large colored ACCEPT ALL beside small gray MANAGE PREFERENCES is not a neutral presentation of two options. Neither is a two-tap opt-in against a five-screen opt-out. **Detecting the asymmetry is most of the defense**, because once you see the steering the pattern stops working.

NAME THE PATTERN AND THE HONEST VERSION

WHAT YOU ENCOUNTER	WHAT IT STEERS TOWARD	WHAT AN HONEST VERSION WOULD LOOK LIKE
Accept-all is one tap, rejecting takes five screens		
"No thanks, I prefer irrelevant ads" as the decline option		
Permission requested mid-task, with only Allow and Not Now		
Account deletion buried; deactivation offered instead		
A countdown timer on an offer that renews indefinitely		
Pre-ticked consent boxes below the fold		

QUESTION 1

Confirmshaming, in row 2, works by making the decline option socially uncomfortable. Explain why it is effective even on people who recognize exactly what it is doing.

QUESTION 2

Several jurisdictions now require that rejecting tracking be as easy as accepting it. Argue whether design regulation of this kind is the right tool, and name one cost of your position.

Attention, Ranking and Controls

What engagement optimization actually does

A feed ranked by predicted engagement is not ranked by accuracy, importance, or whether it leaves you better off. Content that provokes strong reaction predicts engagement well, so it is promoted. **No one has to intend this outcome for it to occur reliably**, which is what makes it a structural problem rather than a question of anyone's motives.

QUESTION 1

Explain why an engagement-ranked feed systematically advantages outrage over accuracy, without assuming bad intent anywhere in the system.

CONTROLS AUDIT: EFFECT, NOT PROMINENCE

Mark each control: does it reduce **collection**, change only **what you see**, or both?

CONTROL	COLLECTION	WHAT YOU SEE	WORTH DOING?
Turning off ad personalization			
Setting location to "while using" rather than "always"			
Clearing your watch or search history			
Revoking contacts access			
Using a browser that blocks third-party trackers			
Deleting apps you no longer use			

QUESTION 2

Two of these change what you are shown without meaningfully reducing what is collected. Identify them and explain why that distinction matters.

QUESTION 3

Respond to: "Privacy is already gone, so none of this is worth doing." Give the strongest version of the claim, then your answer.

Lesson 4: Verification and Synthetic Media

Students build a verification routine that survives generated images, audio and video, and examine why smart people are not harder to fool.

Students will be able to

- Apply lateral reading and trace a claim to its original source.
- Explain why detecting synthetic media by inspection is unreliable and what replaces it.
- Identify motivated reasoning in their own evaluation of a claim.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 55 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

Every traditional signal of credibility can now be manufactured. What is left?

RUNNING THE LESSON

0 to 10 The signals that stopped working

List what people historically used to judge credibility: professional appearance, confident delivery, photographic evidence, video, audio of a familiar voice. Cross each one off. All are now cheap to manufacture. This is a genuine epistemic change and it deserves to be stated as one.

10 to 22 Lateral reading, and the liar's dividend

Teach the move: leave the page, check the source against independent sources, find the original. Then introduce the liar's dividend: once everyone knows fakes exist, anyone caught on genuine record can claim it was fabricated. Note that the second problem is now larger than the first.

22 to 38 Student pages 1 and 2

Students practice lateral reading and evaluate claims including one that is genuinely unresolvable. Do not let them force a verdict on it.

38 to 49 Student page 3

Provenance, and motivated reasoning. The self-audit is the most uncomfortable and most valuable part of the lesson.

49 to 55 Land it

Ask which claims they scrutinize least. Answer: the ones they already agree with. Exit ticket 4 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Lateral reading	Evaluating a source by leaving it and consulting independent sources about it.
Provenance	The documented origin and modification history of a piece of media.
Motivated reasoning	Evaluating evidence more or less strictly depending on whether it supports what you already believe.
Liar's dividend	The advantage gained when the existence of convincing fakes allows genuine evidence to be dismissed.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Provide the three lateral questions on a desk card. The task is executing the routine, not recalling it.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to construct the most persuasive false claim they can aimed at people who share their own views, then specify the check that defeats it. The second half carries the assessment.

WATCH FOR

Use fictional or historical examples rather than live political ones. Current examples convert a skills lesson into a partisan argument and students disengage along lines set at home.

Lateral Reading

What professional fact-checkers do differently

Presented with an unfamiliar site, most people read it more carefully: design, tone, citations, the About page. Every one of those signals is authored by the site itself.

Fact-checkers leave within seconds and search for what independent sources say about the source. This is **lateral reading**. It is faster and substantially more accurate, and it is the single largest behavioral difference between expert and non-expert evaluators.

THE ROUTINE

- 1 Who is behind this, per independent sources? Ownership, funding, track record.
- 2 What is the original source? Walk back through the chain to the study, filing, or footage. Most claims are three or more steps removed.
- 3 Who else reports it, independently? Outlets citing each other are one source, not several.

EXECUTE IT

WHAT YOU ENCOUNTER	FIRST SEARCH YOU RUN	WHAT WOULD ACTUALLY SETTLE IT
An institute you have never heard of publishes a policy report		
A post says "a new study shows" with no citation		
Six outlets report the same claim within an hour		
A screenshot of a headline with no link		
A chart with no axis labels and no source		

QUESTION 1

Row 3 looks like strong corroboration and often is not. Explain the failure mode.

QUESTION 2

Explain why the About page of a source is nearly worthless as evidence about that source.

Four Claims

Run the routine on each. One is genuinely unresolvable on the evidence given, and **uncertain** is the correct verdict for it.

CLAIM A

A video shows a public official saying something inflammatory. Lip sync is convincing. Posted by an account created eleven days ago. No major outlet has reported it after six hours.

SOURCE?	ORIGINAL?	INDEPENDENT CORROBORATION?	VERDICT

CLAIM B

A peer-reviewed paper in an established journal reports a modest effect. A viral post describes it as a breakthrough that will transform treatment.

SOURCE?	ORIGINAL?	INDEPENDENT CORROBORATION?	VERDICT

CLAIM C

A public official, recorded on a genuine broadcast, later states that the recording is an AI fabrication. No forensic analysis has been published.

SOURCE?	ORIGINAL?	INDEPENDENT CORROBORATION?	VERDICT

CLAIM D

An individual with a long-standing ordinary account describes a serious adverse reaction to a widely used product. No other reports exist.

SOURCE?	ORIGINAL?	INDEPENDENT CORROBORATION?	VERDICT

QUESTION

Claim C is the **liar's dividend**: the existence of fakes lets genuine evidence be denied. Explain why this is now a larger problem than fabricated media itself.

Provenance and Your Own Blind Spot

STOP TRYING TO SPOT FAKES BY EYE

Advice about counting fingers and watching for unnatural blinking is already obsolete, and detection tools are unreliable at the moment you need them. **Inspection is not a strategy. Provenance is.** Ask where it came from, who published it first, and whether independent records of the same event exist.

PROVENANCE IN PRACTICE

THE MEDIA	THE PROVENANCE QUESTION THAT HELPS MOST	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT
Dramatic footage of a public event, one clip only		
Audio of a known voice making an admission		
A crowd photo used to show scale		
A celebrity endorsing an investment platform		

QUESTION 1

Row 1: explain why a genuine public event almost always produces multiple independent recordings, and what a single clip therefore implies.

SELF-AUDIT: MOTIVATED REASONING

People do not apply verification evenly. Claims that confirm what we already believe get waved through; claims that contradict us get interrogated. Being intelligent does not fix this. It supplies better arguments for the conclusion you already reached.

PROMPT	YOUR ANSWER
The last thing you shared without checking. What made it feel safe to share?	
A claim you accepted quickly. Would you have applied the same scrutiny if it had contradicted you?	
One rule you will adopt to slow yourself down on agreeable claims.	

Lesson 5: Consent, Harassment and the Law

Students examine consent in digital contexts and the legal exposure that surprises people, including where sharing itself is the offense.

Students will be able to

- Apply the elements of consent to digital sharing situations.
- Explain why forwarding is participation rather than observation.
- Identify reporting pathways, including removal services for intimate images.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- Board
- Pens

Time: 55 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

Consent to one person, at one moment, for one purpose. What does that actually cover?

RUNNING THE LESSON

0 to 10 Unpack consent into four elements

Freely given, specific, informed, revocable. Write them up. Then apply to a mundane case: a friend agreeing to a photo at a party has consented to the photo being taken, not to it being posted, tagged, cropped, or reshared two years later. Consent is not a permanent unlimited license, and most disputes are failures of specificity.

10 to 24 The legal exposure students do not expect

Two points. Intimate images of anyone under 18 are child sexual abuse material under federal law **regardless of who created them or who is depicted**, which means a minor can face serious consequences for possessing or forwarding images of a peer or of themselves. And non-consensual distribution of intimate images is a crime in nearly every state, with laws varying. Deliver this factually, without threatening the class.

24 to 39 Student pages 1 and 2

Students apply the consent elements, then work through scenarios involving forwarding, coercion and reporting. Emphasize that forwarding is a decision with its own consequences.

39 to 50 Student page 3

Reporting pathways and support for someone disclosing. Give students the actual services rather than a general instruction to tell someone.

50 to 55 Land it

State plainly: a person who is targeted has done nothing wrong, and the responsibility rests entirely on the person who shared or threatened. Exit ticket 5 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Consent	Freely given, specific, informed and revocable agreement. All four elements are required.
Image-based abuse	Sharing or threatening to share intimate images without consent.
Coercion	Pressure that removes the freely given element, including persistence, threats and manipulation.
Take It Down	A free NCMEC service that helps remove intimate images of minors from participating platforms.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Provide the four consent elements as a desk card. Students apply them accurately with the card and unevenly without it.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to compare two states' laws on non-consensual distribution and write a short brief on where they differ and why the difference matters.

WATCH FOR

This lesson has the highest chance of surfacing a live situation. Watch for a student who disengages, leaves, or asks an unusually specific procedural question. Follow up privately the same day and follow your school's reporting process. Do not promise confidentiality.

Four Elements of Consent

Consent is not a single yes

Freely given. Not obtained through pressure, persistence, threat, or an imbalance of power.

Specific. To this act, this audience, this purpose. Agreement to one thing is not agreement to a category.

Informed. The person knew what they were agreeing to, including who would see it.

Revocable. It can be withdrawn, and withdrawal applies from that moment forward.

APPLY ALL FOUR

Mark each element met or not met, then give your judgment.

SITUATION	FREE	SPECIFIC	INFORMED	REVOCABLE	JUDGMENT
A friend agrees to a photo. You post it publicly the next day.					
Someone agrees after being asked repeatedly across a week.					
A group photo is reshared two years later, cropped to one person.					
Someone consented, then asks you to take it down.					
A private message is screenshotted and shared to prove a point.					
Someone agrees while being told everyone else already has.					

QUESTION 1

Row 2 is repeated asking. Explain how persistence undermines the freely-given element, even with no threat.

QUESTION 2

Row 3 shows consent failing on specificity while the original agreement was real. Explain why the passage of time and the change of framing matter.

Forwarding Is a Decision

THE LEGAL POSITION, STATED PLAINLY

Under federal law, sexual images of anyone under 18 are child sexual abuse material **regardless of who took them, who is depicted, or whether everyone involved is also a minor**. Creating, possessing, requesting, or forwarding them carries serious legal consequences, including for minors.

Separately, nearly every state criminalizes distributing intimate images of an adult without consent. The details vary by state; the existence of the offense generally does not.

WHERE DOES RESPONSIBILITY SIT?

THE ACTION	RESPONSIBILITY	REASONING
Taking an image with consent		
Sharing it with one other person		
Receiving it and not forwarding it		
Receiving it and forwarding it once		
Screenshotting it "as evidence" and keeping it		
Threatening to share unless someone complies		

QUESTION 1

Row 4 is forwarding once, to one person. Argue why "I only sent it to one person" fails both as a legal defense and as a moral one.

QUESTION 2

Row 5 is keeping an image with the stated intention of documenting wrongdoing. Explain why this is still a serious problem, and describe what someone should do instead.

QUESTION 3

Someone facing a threat to share images is frequently blamed for having produced them. Write the clearest answer you can to that reasoning.

Reporting and Supporting

If someone is threatening to share images

Do not pay, and do not send more. Compliance has never ended a demand. It confirms the method works and escalation follows.

Do not delete the conversation. The instinct is to erase everything. Evidence is what lets platforms and police act. Screenshot, then stop responding.

Report it. In the platform, to a trusted adult, and to the services below.

Understand the position. This is a crime committed against the person targeted. They have done nothing wrong, and there are people whose actual job is to fix it.

WHERE TO REPORT

SERVICE	WHAT IT DOES
NCMEC Take It Down	Free service that helps remove intimate images of people who were under 18, from participating platforms.
NCMEC CyberTipline	The national reporting channel for exploitation of minors.
StopNCII.org	Equivalent service for adults, using image hashes so the image itself is never uploaded.
The platform's own report tool	Fastest removal route, and it creates a record. Use it in addition to, not instead of, the above.
A trusted adult at school	Triggers school processes and support. Write the name below.

THE PERSON AT MY SCHOOL WHOSE JOB THIS IS

IF SOMEONE TELLS YOU IT IS HAPPENING TO THEM

Write what you would say in the first thirty seconds. The first response shapes whether they tell anyone else.

QUESTION

Name three things **not** to say to someone disclosing this, and explain the damage each one does.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Lesson 6: Money, Fraud and Manipulation

Students examine the psychology behind fraud and the specific schemes that target their age group.

Students will be able to

- Name the psychological levers common to fraud and identify them in unfamiliar approaches.
- Recognize schemes that specifically target teenagers and young adults.
- Execute a correctly ordered response, including preserving evidence.

You need

- Student pages 1 to 3
- The help sheet from the back of this pack
- Pens

Time: 55 min

THE BIG QUESTION ON THE BOARD

Fraud is engineered by professionals and tested at scale. So why do we treat victims as if they were careless?

RUNNING THE LESSON

0 to 10 Dismantle the competence framing

Open with the evidence: fraud losses are concentrated among people who consider themselves difficult to fool, and younger adults report fraud at higher rates than older ones on many scheme types. Confidence is a risk factor, not a defense. This reframing is the precondition for anyone reporting anything.

10 to 23 Six levers

Urgency, authority, scarcity, reciprocity, social proof, and commitment. Walk each with an example. Emphasize commitment: once someone has invested money, effort, or identity in a scheme, sunk cost keeps them in it long after the warning signs are obvious. This is why victims continue paying.

23 to 39 Student pages 1 and 2

Students identify levers, then analyze schemes aimed at their age group: job scams, money mule recruitment, marketplace fraud, investment schemes, and sextortion. The money mule material is the one they are least likely to have heard and most likely to encounter.

39 to 50 Student page 3

Response protocol and the help sheet from the back of this pack, completed in class.

50 to 55 Land it

Ask which lever explains why people keep paying after they suspect. Answer: commitment and sunk cost. Exit ticket 6 at the door.

WORDS STUDENTS NEED

Social engineering Manipulating people rather than defeating systems.

Money mule Someone who moves criminal proceeds through their own account, often without understanding the offense.

Advance fee fraud Requiring a payment up front to release a promised larger benefit that never arrives.

Recovery scam Targeting previous victims with an offer to recover their losses for a fee.

IF THEY NEED SUPPORT

Reduce the scheme set from five to three and provide the lever definitions on a desk card.

IF THEY FINISH EARLY

Ask students to design the fraud-awareness intervention they think would actually work on their own age group, and to explain why the standard version does not.

WATCH FOR

A student may recognize a current situation, particularly in the sextortion or money mule material. Watch for someone who goes quiet or asks a very specific procedural question. Follow up privately the same day.

Six Levers

THE COMPETENCE TRAP

Fraud is designed by teams, tested on large populations, and refined until the conversion rate is acceptable. People who believe they are too smart to be targeted check less carefully and are therefore easier to convert. **Confidence is a risk factor.** And shame is what keeps people from reporting, which is what allows the same scheme to run again.

The levers

Urgency. A deadline removes verification.

Authority. Impersonating an institution, an employer, or a platform.

Scarcity. Limited spots, limited supply, one chance.

Reciprocity. A gift or favor first, creating a felt obligation.

Social proof. Testimonials, screenshots of returns, apparent popularity.

Commitment. Once you have invested money, effort, or identity, sunk cost keeps you in. **This is why people keep paying after they suspect.**

IDENTIFY THE LEVERS

THE APPROACH	LEVERS	THE STRONGEST TELL
"Remote role, \$900 a week, no experience. Start Monday, three spots left."		
"Your account is under review. Verify within 24 hours to avoid suspension."		
"I made \$40k in six weeks. Screenshots below. DM for the strategy."		
"Send the deposit and I will hold the item for you."		
"We can recover the money you lost. Our fee is paid up front."		
"Your package could not be delivered. Update your address here."		

QUESTION

Row 5 targets people who have already been defrauded once. Explain why previous victims are a disproportionately valuable target, and which lever does most of the work.

Schemes Aimed At You

1. THE JOB THAT IS NOT A JOB

A remote role with unusual pay for the work involved. They send a check to buy equipment and ask you to forward part of it, or ask you to receive payments and pass them on. Explain what is actually happening, and what a **money mule** is.

Money mule offenses can be charged even when the person did not know the funds were criminal. Explain why "I did not know" is a weak defense here.

2. THE INVESTMENT WITH PROOF

Screenshots of returns, a group chat of enthusiastic members, small withdrawals honored early, and pressure to increase the position. Name the two levers doing the most work and explain the early-withdrawal tactic.

3. MARKETPLACE AND TICKET FRAUD

Below-market price, a reason the item must move fast, and a request to pay by a method with no buyer protection. Name two payment methods with no recovery route and say what to use instead.

4. SEXTORTION

Contact, rapid warmth, a request for images, then a threat to send them to your contacts unless you pay. Write the three rules.

1.

2.

3.

Paying does not end the demand. Explain why, in terms of the sender's incentives.

Response Protocol

If it has already happened

- 1 **Stop transacting.** No further payments, no further contact. Sunk cost is the argument to ignore.
- 2 **Preserve evidence.** Screenshot everything including usernames, timestamps, and payment references. Do not delete the thread.
- 3 **Contact the bank or payment provider immediately.** Speed determines whether funds can be recovered. Hours matter.
- 4 **Secure accounts.** Passwords, phishing-resistant MFA, sessions revoked, recovery details checked.
- 5 **Report.** The platform, and the FTC at reportfraud.ftc.gov. For anyone under 18, NCMEC. For threats involving images, see Lesson 5.
- 6 **Tell someone.** An adult you trust. Today.

QUESTION 1

Step 3 is the most time-sensitive and the most commonly delayed, because people spend hours hoping they are wrong. Explain the cost of that delay.

QUESTION 2

Most fraud goes unreported. Give two reasons, and explain what under-reporting does to the next target.

YOUR SCRIPT

Write the first sentence you would use to tell someone. Having the words ready is what makes it happen.

MY THREE CONTACTS

WHO	HOW I WOULD REACH THEM

THE FRAMING THAT MATTERS

Being defrauded is something done to you by a professional. The only decision that is genuinely yours is how quickly you tell someone.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Skills Rubric

One rubric for all six lessons. Circle a level per row, or use it as a self-assessment.

SKILL	BEGINNING	DEVELOPING	SECURE	STRONG
Managing the record	Treats posts as the whole record.	Recognizes permanence but not inference.	Distinguishes disclosed, observed and inferred data.	Predicts and evaluates the profile a reader would construct.
Account security	Reuses credentials across services.	Knows reuse is risky but has not acted.	Explains credential stuffing and uses MFA.	Ranks factors against named attacks and sequences a breach response.
Data and systems	Accepts defaults without noticing design.	Knows data is collected but not how value is created.	Explains the inference pipeline and names dark patterns.	Evaluates controls by effect rather than prominence.
Verification	Judges credibility by presentation.	Skeptical but without a routine.	Reads laterally and traces to original sources.	Reaches uncertain verdicts and audits own motivated reasoning.
Consent and law	Treats consent as a single yes.	Knows consent matters but not its elements.	Applies all four elements accurately.	Analyzes responsibility across a chain and knows reporting pathways.
Responding to fraud	Would not report.	Would report eventually.	Names the protocol and the priority order.	Would act within hours, preserve evidence, and support someone else doing the same.

HOW TO USE IT WITHOUT CREATING MARKING

- **Pick two rows, not five.** Assess the two skills the lesson actually taught. Leave the rest blank.
- **Have students circle first.** Then you circle. The conversation is about the gap between the two, and it takes thirty seconds per student.
- **Use it twice.** Once after Lesson 2 and once at the end. The movement between the two is the evidence, not the final score.

REPORTING LANGUAGE

Useful phrases: *distinguishes disclosed, observed and inferred data, evaluates authentication factors against specific attack types, applies the elements of consent to digital contexts, reads laterally and traces claims to original sources, identifies manipulation techniques in unfamiliar approaches, sequences an incident response under time pressure.*

Exit Tickets

Cut along the dashed lines. One ticket per student per lesson. Collect at the door.

Exit Ticket — Lesson 1

Name one inference a reader could draw about you that you never disclosed. What will you change?

Exit Ticket — Lesson 2

Why does a passkey defeat a real-time phishing page when an authenticator code does not?

Exit Ticket — Lesson 3

Name one control that reduces collection and one that only changes what you see.

Exit Ticket — Lesson 4

What is the liar's dividend, and why is it a larger problem than fabricated media?

Exit Ticket — Lesson 5

Name the four elements of consent. Which one fails most often, and why?

Exit Ticket — Lesson 6

Which lever explains why people keep paying after they suspect a scam?

Letter Home

Print, add your school letterhead, and send. The tone is deliberately calm rather than alarming.

Dear families,

Over the next few weeks your student is studying digital citizenship and online safety. The six lessons cover their online record and how it will be read, account security and breach response, how personal data becomes commercially valuable, verifying information in an era of AI-generated media, consent and the law around sharing images, and the fraud schemes that specifically target young adults.

Two lessons cover difficult material directly. One states the legal position on intimate images, including that images of anyone under 18 are treated as child sexual abuse material under federal law regardless of who created them, and that minors have faced charges. Another covers fraud, including schemes that recruit young people to move criminal funds through their own bank accounts without realizing what they are doing. Both are taught factually and without graphic detail. If you would like to review either lesson beforehand, please ask.

One thing to do at home: tell your student explicitly that if something goes wrong online, whether money, images, or an account, they should come to you and will not lose access to their devices for it. Fear of losing access and fear of blame are the two most common reasons young people delay reporting, and delay is what turns a recoverable problem into a serious one.

With thanks,

Teacher name and contact

WHY THIS LETTER IS SHORT

Long safety letters get skimmed. This one does three things only: says what is being taught, gives one thing to do at home, and names the fact that families can ask questions. That is the maximum that reliably gets read.

IF A FAMILY ASKS FOR MORE

THEY ASK	A SHORT ANSWER THAT WORKS
"Are you teaching them about things they have not even heard of yet?"	No. Every topic here is one students already meet. The lessons name it rather than introduce it, which is what lets a child recognize it later.
"Should I be reading their messages?"	That is a family decision, not a school one. What helps most in either case is that a child expects to be helped rather than punished when they report a problem.
"What if we do not allow devices at home?"	The lessons still apply. Students use school devices, friends' devices, and eventually their own. The habits transfer.
"Can I see the materials?"	Yes, and say yes readily. Every page is printable and there is nothing in the pack you would not want a family to read.

My Help Sheet

Fill this in **now**, while nothing is wrong. Then fold it and keep it somewhere you will find it.

THREE ADULTS I COULD TELL

One at home, one at school, one anywhere else. Write the name and how you would reach them.

1.

2.

3.

AT MY SCHOOL, THE PERSON WHOSE JOB THIS IS

Your teacher will give you this name.

Three things that are always true

- **You will not be in trouble for telling.** Not for what you clicked, sent, paid, or how long you waited.
- **It was engineered.** Fraud and coercion are built by professionals and tested at scale. Being targeted successfully is not a character flaw.
- **Hours matter.** Payment reversals, evidence preservation, and image removal all depend on speed.

FREE HELP LINES

IF THIS IS HAPPENING	WHO TO CONTACT
Intimate images of you shared or threatened	Take It Down (NCMEC) if you were under 18. StopNCII.org if adult. Report in the platform too.
You have lost money to a scam	Contact your bank or payment provider immediately, then report at reportfraud.ftc.gov .
Someone else has accessed your account	Secure email first, then change passwords, revoke sessions, and check recovery settings.
Someone is harassing or threatening you	Screenshot with usernames and timestamps, report in the platform, and tell an adult today.

THE ONE SENTENCE TO REMEMBER

Preserve the evidence, stop responding, and tell someone today. Speed is the one variable you control.

Answer Key

Model answers, not the only answers. For open questions, accept any response that meets the criterion named in bold.

LESSON 1: REPUTATION AND THE RECORD

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Q1	Disclosed is easiest to change; inferred has the largest effect. They differ because control and consequence sit in different tiers, which is the core asymmetry.
P1 Q2	Criterion: identifies that inferences are often invisible, undisclosed, proprietary, and not subject to correction rights , so there is frequently no mechanism to contest them.
P2 Conclusions	Available: school and graduation year, sport, employer, approximate location, social circle, a prior deleted account, taste and reading, and a personality read from tone. Confidence is high on factual items and low on character inferences.
P2 Q1	A consistent username links otherwise separate records into one profile, which is what converts scattered fragments into a searchable dossier.
P2 Q2	Discount: age 14, developmental change, no pattern since, context unavailable. Weigh: a named target was harmed, the record is public, and a reader has no way to verify that change occurred.
P3 Table	Row 1 mostly yes. Rows 2, 3 and 5 no. Row 4 partially, depending on platform retention. Remedies: request removal, contact the poster, de-index requests, and reduce future production.
P3 Q2	Criterion: names a genuine cost of the position taken , for example public-interest journalism and accountability records versus rehabilitation and proportionality.

LESSON 2: ACCOUNT SECURITY AND BREACH RESPONSE

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Table	All accounts sharing the credential fall unless protected by MFA or a passkey. Email is the highest consequence because it controls resets.
P1 Q1	Control of email allows initiation and completion of password resets across all linked services, making it the master key regardless of contents.
P1 Q2	Forced rotation produced predictable incremental variants, increased reuse, and drove written-down passwords. NIST now recommends changing on evidence of compromise.
P2 Grid	Reused password: no help anywhere. Manager: stops stuffing, no help against phishing. SMS: slows stuffing, fails phishing and SIM swap. App code: stops stuffing, fails real-time phishing. Hardware key and passkey: stop stuffing and phishing; device theft while unlocked remains a risk.
P2 Q1	An app code is a shared secret the user relays, so a relay page can forward it. A passkey is bound to the origin and signs a challenge, so a fake domain gets nothing usable.
P2 Q2	Universal device support, no enrollment friction, and legacy system compatibility. Accept cost and user familiarity.
P3 Part A	Email first, revoke sessions, audit forwarding and recovery, change reused credentials, revoke third-party authorizations, enable MFA, notify contacts, tell an adult.
P3 Part B	Forwarding rules, altered recovery address or phone, app-specific passwords, OAuth grants, active sessions, and added trusted devices. All survive a password change.

Answer Key (continued)

LESSON 3: DATA, INFERENCE AND ATTENTION

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Chain	Accept plausible chains. Scroll slowdown to interest to ad targeting. Overlapping location to relationship to household targeting. Unscented products to pregnancy or sensitivity to life-stage marketing. Overnight use to sleep disruption or distress to wellness or gambling targeting. Deleted search to sensitive concern. Battery to heavy use to device replacement timing.
P1 Q1	Sensitivity arises at the inference, not the observation. Buying unscented soap is trivial; the pregnancy inference is not. The data was never sensitive; the conclusion is.
P1 Q2	Shadow profiles built from other users' contact uploads, tracking pixels on third-party sites, data broker purchases, and inference from people demographically or socially similar.
P2 Patterns	Asymmetric friction, confirmshaming, badgering at a moment of low attention, obstruction, false urgency, and pre-selection. Honest versions equalize effort and default to the privacy-protective choice.
P2 Q1	It operates on social discomfort rather than belief, so recognizing the mechanism does not remove the feeling. Awareness is a weak defense against affective manipulation.
P3 Q1	Criterion: explains a structural mechanism without attributing intent. Ranking by predicted engagement selects for provocation because provocation predicts interaction.
P3 Q2	Ad personalization off and history clearing largely change presentation. Location limits, contacts revocation, tracker blocking and app deletion reduce collection.

LESSON 4: VERIFICATION AND SYNTHETIC MEDIA

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Table	Search the organization plus funding or ownership. Search the claim plus study to reach the original. For simultaneous reports, check whether all trace to one wire item. Search headline text. For the chart, search the underlying data source.
P1 Q1	Simultaneous publication usually indicates a single upstream source syndicated widely. That is one source, not six, and it is a common false corroboration signal.
P1 Q2	It is self-authored, so it is evidence of what the source wishes to project, not of what it is.
P2 Claim A	Treat as false pending corroboration. New account, no independent reporting, high emotional payload.
P2 Claim B	Underlying finding likely sound; the viral characterization is not. The distortion is in the summary.
P2 Claim C	Uncertain, and this is the liar's dividend. A genuine record is denied using the general availability of fakes.
P2 Claim D	Uncertain. A single report is neither evidence of a pattern nor evidence of dishonesty.
P2 Question	Fabrication requires effort and can be checked; denial is free, unfalsifiable in the moment, and degrades trust in all evidence including genuine records.
P3 Self-audit	No correct answers. Criterion: the student identifies an actual instance rather than a hypothetical one.

Answer Key (continued)

LESSON 5: CONSENT, HARASSMENT AND THE LAW

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Table	Row 1 fails specificity. Row 2 fails freely given. Row 3 fails specificity and arguably informed. Row 4 fails revocability if not removed. Row 5 fails all four. Row 6 fails freely given and informed.
P1 Q1	Repeated asking converts refusal into a cost the person must keep paying. Eventual agreement reflects exhaustion rather than willingness, so the freely-given element fails.
P1 Q2	Consent was specific to a moment, an audience and a framing. Cropping isolates the person, and time changes both audience and meaning, so the original agreement no longer covers the use.
P2 Responsibility	Rows 2, 4, 5 and 6 carry responsibility. Row 3 does not, provided the recipient does not forward and reports it. Row 6 is the most serious and is a criminal offense.
P2 Q1	Legally, distribution is distribution regardless of the number of recipients. Morally, it removes the person's control entirely, since the second recipient is under no constraint.
P2 Q2	Possession is the offense where a minor is depicted, and intent does not cure it. The correct action is to not retain the image, and to report to a trusted adult or the CyberTipline so that people with legal authority handle the evidence.
P2 Q3	Criterion: locates responsibility with the person who threatened or distributed , and identifies victim-blaming as a mechanism that suppresses reporting and protects offenders.
P3 Question	Avoid: asking why they sent it; reacting with visible shock or disgust; promising secrecy. Each shifts blame, discourages disclosure, or creates a promise that cannot be kept.

LESSON 6: MONEY, FRAUD AND MANIPULATION

PAGE AND QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
P1 Table	1: scarcity, urgency, reward. 2: authority, urgency. 3: social proof, reward. 4: reciprocity, urgency. 5: authority, commitment. 6: authority, urgency.
P1 Question	Prior victims are pre-qualified as responsive and are motivated by loss recovery. Commitment and sunk cost do the work.
P2 Job scam	The check is fraudulent and will be reversed after the forwarded funds are gone, or the person is being recruited as a money mule. Money mule offenses can be charged on a willful blindness standard, so not asking obvious questions is not a defense.
P2 Investment	Social proof and commitment. Early small withdrawals are honored to establish credibility and induce a larger deposit.
P2 Marketplace	No recovery: gift cards, wire transfers, crypto, and friends-and-family payment transfers. Use a method with buyer protection, and meet in person where possible.
P2 Sextortion	Do not pay, do not send more, do not delete evidence. Report and tell an adult. Payment identifies a paying target and escalation follows, so demands increase rather than stop.
P3 Q1	Reversal and recall windows are short. Delay converts a recoverable transfer into a permanent loss.
P3 Q2	Shame and an expectation that nothing will be done. Under-reporting removes enforcement signal and leaves the scheme running against the next target.

IF YOU ONLY MARK ONE THING

Read the Lesson 6 page 3 contacts and the Lesson 5 page 3 responses. A student who cannot name an adult, or who would respond to a disclosure badly, is the reason this pack exists.



Thank You

Built by a classroom teacher who still teaches this every year.

If this worked in your room

- **Leaving feedback earns you TPT credits** toward future purchases, and it genuinely helps other teachers find the pack.
- **Found a typo or a thing that did not land?** Message me through TPT. I fix things and re-upload, and you get the update free.
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THREE THINGS WORTH DOING AFTER THIS PACK

- **Put the help sheet somewhere permanent.** Inside a folder, on the inside of a locker door, in the back of a planner. It only works if it is findable in the moment it is needed.
- **Revisit one idea a month.** Two minutes at the start of a period. Ask what students have noticed since. This is what turns six lessons into a culture.
- **Tell your colleagues the reporting name.** The most common failure in a school is not that students do not report, it is that the adult they told did not know where to send it.

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